

GAME JAM PROPOSAL: EARTHFALL

A 3v1 Asymmetric Superhero Defense Game

EARTHFALL is an asymmetric superhero defense game set during a large-scale attack on Earth[cite: 13]. Five defenders protect a living Earth-defense network while an attacking team tries to mislead them, overload their resources, and break through to Earth's core[cite: 12].

Teammates:

Neshanth Y

Lalitha K

Koushik J

Karthik K

Project Specifications

- **Format:** 3v1 asymmetric team game.
- **Defenders:** 1 Commander + 2 Heroes.
- **Attacker:** 1 Mastermind.
- **Themes:** COMIC, TWIST, LIGHT.
- **Target Match:** 5-8 minutes.
- **Platform:** Browser-playable HTML5/WebGL/Godot.

1. Game Overview

Earth is divided into distinct sectors, each featuring a physical shield generator and a hybrid shield composed of three technologies: Kinetic, TIR/Photon, and Arcane[cite: 13]. The defenders never have enough protection to defend everything at once; they must decide where to be strong, while the attacker deliberately tries to make them choose wrong[cite: 12]. The attacker can create false signals, change targets, combine attack

types, and force the defenders to spend their limited resources in the wrong place[cite: 13].

2. The Three Mandatory Themes

- **COMIC:** The game is presented as a living superhero comic: original heroes, stylized action, comic-style alerts, impact effects, action lines, dramatic panels, speech/communication bubbles and bold visual feedback[cite: 13].
- **TWIST:** Attackers can deceive the defenders[cite: 13]. A visible attack may be a feint, a target may change, or a hidden magical/energy component may appear after the defenders commit resources[cite: 13].
- **LIGHT:** Photon/TIR technology is built around light and reflection[cite: 13]. The Commander uses a Light Scan to reveal hidden signatures and help distinguish real threats from deceptive ones[cite: 13].

3. Defender Team (3 Players)

- **Commander (The Eyes & Brain):** Combines information and planetary defense control[cite: 13]. Operates the threat radar, Light Scan, sector warnings, energy transfers, shield ratios, reconfiguration, and heat management[cite: 13].
- **Heroes (Frontline x2):** Focused on physical combat and defense[cite: 13]. They intercept threats, protect generators, hold breaches, and move to the generator to channel repair actions[cite: 13, 14].

4. Attacker Team (1 Player)

- **The Mastermind:** Utilizes deception as a core mechanic to deliberately create ambiguity[cite: 16]. They execute fake attack types (e.g., hiding a magical component inside a visible missile assault), fake targets, resource baits, and mixed attacks to overload a single defense assumption[cite: 16].

5. The Three Shield Technologies

- **Kinetic Barrier:** Strong against missiles, physical projectiles, asteroids, charging enemies and siege units[cite: 14]. Weak against lasers, plasma, and magical intrusion[cite: 14].

- **TIR/Photon Mirror:** Strong against lasers, plasma, beams and energy attacks[cite: 14]. Physical objects pass through with little resistance[cite: 14]. Visually prismatic and light-based[cite: 14].
- **Arcane Ward:** Strong against portals, teleportation, curses and magical entities[cite: 14]. Weak against conventional physical and energy pressure[cite: 14]. Visually runic and unstable[cite: 14].

6. Hybrid Shield Allocation & Reconfiguration

A sector's protection is a dynamic mixture of the three shield technologies[cite: 15]. The Commander can redistribute this composition during the match, but changing a sector's composition starts a transition period where shield effectiveness temporarily decreases, creating a vulnerable window[cite: 15].

Earth relies on one shared defense-energy pool[cite: 15]. The Commander can transfer units from a stable sector to a collapsing one, which creates strategic sacrifice by weakening the drained sector[cite: 15]. Every shield has both Integrity and Heat; keeping a heavily stressed shield active preserves protection but risks a thermal overload shockwave that temporarily shuts it down[cite: 16].

7. Match Phase Structure

- **Opening:** Defenders establish allocations; attackers probe and create early pressure[cite: 18].
- **Escalation:** Threat frequency rises; energy transfers and shield composition become important[cite: 18].
- **Crisis:** Multiple sectors may be threatened; heat, deception and generator failures create pressure[cite: 18].
- **Final Push:** Attackers commit to decisive targets; defenders spend remaining resources and abilities[cite: 18].

8. Technical Architecture & Visual Direction

- **Platform:** Browser-playable HTML5/WebGL[cite: 19].
- **Visual Direction:** The visual target is cinematic sci-fi combined with a tactical command interface[cite: 19]. Features include a stylized central Earth, geometric/hexagonal Kinetic barriers, prismatic translucent TIR barriers, and runic circular Arcane barriers[cite: 19].

9. Jam Compliance & Scope Locks

- All core game code and architecture are developed within the permitted jam period.
- No complete game starter kit, pre-existing game or copied project is used.
- Only permitted free/open-source, Creative Commons, original or AI-generated assets are used.
- Third-party assets are strictly documented in CREDITS.md with source and license information.
- The final submission includes a stable browser-playable build, README, controls and team information.
- **Scope Rule:** If a secondary feature threatens the core playable loop or final build, it is cut. The MVP prioritizes the central interaction loop: PREDICT → ALLOCATE → OBSERVE → RECONFIGURE → OVERHEAT → SACRIFICE → RECOVER.